



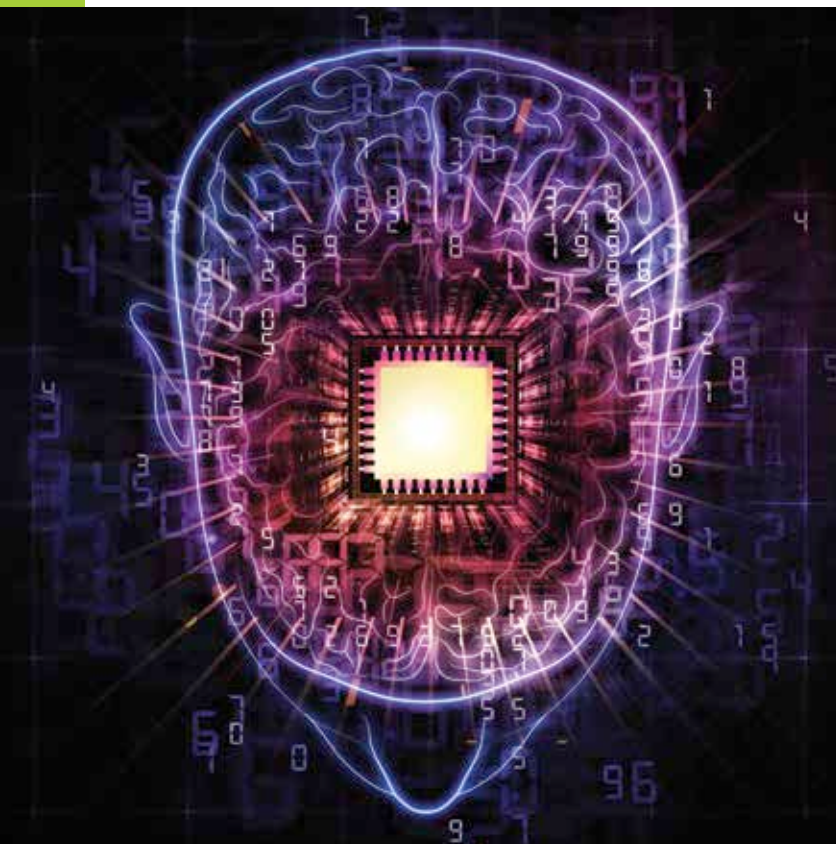
Digg Reader Coming

The long awaited alternative to Google Reader will be available to all users by the 26th of June <http://dgit.in/18VhsMZ>



Xbox One 10X More Powerful

Phil Spencer of Microsoft claims Xbox One to be 10 times more powerful than the Xbox 360. <http://dgit.in/17iVlzw>



The Positronic Brain

Can we ever really hope to have real Artificial Intelligence among us?

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We're sure that half of you would've immediately paused for a second when you read the word 'positronic' in the title. If you did, then God bless you sir (or, ma'am), because we're fellow Asimov fans reminiscing The Positronic Man. Even if that is not the first thing that springs to your mind when you looked at the title, we're sure that Robin Williams' rather-iffy-but-somehow-legendary portrayal of the emotional robot Andrew Martin in 'The Bicentennial Man' is sure to ring a bell. Ahh... there it is. Not sure if you realized it at the time, but that movie, if (or for the more optimistic, 'when') realized in the real world, is the wet dream of about every Artificial Intelligence researcher, ever. But there is a problem that seems to have been encountered in that regard. We have a long, long way to go before we get there. So long that we have almost all of it left to do. George Carlin famously said "Think of how stupid the average

person is, and then realize that half of them are stupider than that". To be fair, that is one scale on which we're still better than our computing machines.

The problem before us

Did you know one of the hardest problems of all time in computing is producing authentically random numbers? We don't kid you here – the games that people play where they have to pick/guess a number from 1 to 10 or whatever, they are one of the things beyond abilities of these supremely capable devices that have basically taken over the world, and thankfully they don't know what to do with it just yet.

Artificial Intelligence started off with great potential, but has not exactly fulfilled its destiny as of yet. "Something huge is around the corner" has been claimed to some degree for the past three decades, and now it seems that the offshoots of Artificial Intelligence, such as Machine Learning and Natural Language Processing have shown measurable progress, resulting in the core aim of Artificial Intelligence being neglected to focus on the sum of the parts.

What we do

One of the first tests that were proposed in Artificial Intelligence was the Turing Test, which is an alteration of the Classic Imitation game. The game proposes that there be three participants, which are isolated from each other, and can only communicate through written media. Let the three people be called A, B and C. A and B are participants, while C is the observer. The motive for A is to mislead the observation of C, while the motive for B is to help the observation.

If, at the end, the observer cannot distinguish between A and B, i.e., as many errors are made with A as with B, then the test is said to have been passed. In the alteration by Turing, the role of A is fulfilled by a computing machine, while B is represented by a human. Therefore, if the observer (human, again) cannot identify either conversations with both, then the machine is said to have been passed.

But for now, the agenda at making this possible is through breaking down the problem into very small pieces, and then to tie them together and hope that the deciphered meaning was sufficiently